



PAWAN BHAWAL

km from Hubli in Karnataka. They called themselves the Islamic Movement (IM). Trouble had been brewing within the organisation since 2006 when general secretary Nagori quarrelled with moderate president Shahid Badar Falahi and marched out with a dozen key followers.

TAUQIR: THE BOMB MAKER

Tauqir alias Abdus Subhan, now believed to be the man who fashioned the IEDs used in Gujarat and Jaipur, was referred to in several confessions of the IM activists. He is spoken of as a software expert and bomb maker and hails from Mira Road, a Mumbai suburb.

ROLE MODEL: MP Police with SIMI propaganda

terrorism agency will integrate intelligence gathering and investigation."

Here are some of the revelations from the interrogation reports, made available exclusively to INDIA TODAY:

Hafiz Hussain, a Nagori aide, reveals that the training included remaining UNDER WATER for five minutes, 'to prepare for carrying out actions in the future, sometime in 2009'.

THE BIRTH OF THE NAGORI FACTION

A week before seven bombs ripped the commuter trains in Mumbai killing nearly 200 people, Safdar Nagori held the first meeting of his breakaway faction. The venue was the farmhouse of a SIMI sympathiser and president of the Madhya Pradesh zone, Kamruddin, in Ujjain between July 5 and 6, 2006. Participants at the meeting included Shibily Peedikackal (secretary general/SIMI), Ehatesham believed to be behind the train bombings and Abdus Subhan (secretary, Maharashtra zone). The meeting targeted individuals who had allegedly perpetrated atrocities against Muslims during the communal riots at Meerut and Gujarat. They identified individuals who had figured in the Srikrishna Commission report. Soon after this meeting, Ehatesham was arrested for his alleged role in the Mumbai blasts. Nagori claims he had no inkling about his involvement but got suspicious when he received a letter from him in jail seeking forgiveness for his 'action'.

THE ISLAMIC MOVEMENT

On April 25, 2007, Nagori and a dozen key aides gathered by the riverside at Castle Rock, 80

FABRICATION OF BOMBS

In November 2007, the Pakistan-trained Naser met Hafiz Hussain, a final year engineering student from Mangalore, and spoke of his training given by LET and ISI near Karachi and Lahore. His training included making bombs with locally available material. He was informed about the use of Hydrogen Peroxide (H_2O_2) to prepare bombs that are more powerful than RDX. He also said that H_2O_2 with 90 per cent concentration was needed to make bombs.

SELECTING TARGETS

Naser said motorcycles could be placed at targeted spots to create havoc (they later used bicycles) and they discussed possible targets—pubs, bars, casinos owned by Jews and Christians in Goa and frequented by foreigners, US software companies based in Bangalore and businessmen from Gujarat. Naser said he would go in search of H_2O_2 which is used in paper mills.

THE 'CONTACT BRIDGES'

IM members were aware that their phones were being tapped. To avoid this, they evolved a system of 'contact bridges' to pass on information. The members contacted these 'bridges'—Hafiz Hussain and Shibily who possessed cellphones—only from PCs to avoid interception. The Internet was used, but only in an emergency, to contact each other.

with Ambresh Mishra

